

**Customer Discovery Interview #1**  
Week 3 | BUS 395: Venture Creation with AI

---

Interviewer: Jane Dias

Interviewee: Allison G. (Larger budget for clothing but still mindful with spending, in her 40s)

Customer Segment: Expressed having unique body type: Tall

Date: June 7, 2026

Length: 12 minutes

Location: Over the phone

Recording: Granola (audio + transcript)

## **TRANSCRIPT**

**Jane:**

Allison, is it okay if I record? All right. Thank you so much for doing this today.

**Allison:**

Yep, that's completely fine.

**Jane:**

Okay. So I'm working on a class project and basically I'm trying to understand how women make decisions when shopping for clothing and how they feel about the clothes they buy and wear. So there's no right or wrong answers. I'm just interested in hearing about your actual experiences. So for my first question, walk me through the last time you went shopping for clothing alone. Did you try things on? How did you decide what to buy? And do you feel satisfied with your purchase? And did you return anything?

**Allison:**

Sure. So the last time I went shopping alone, I went to the mall and I actually walked through a lot of stores. I ended up stopping at Anthropologie, picking up quite a few things to try on in the fitting room. And I walked out with one item, I believe, after trying on several. So I have gotten to the point where I definitely like to try on clothes before I buy them. I don't enjoy going back to stores to return dates. So I want to be really certain when I leave the store that I actually want to take that item home, that I feel good about it, that I'm confident wearing it. So that's, that's typically what I do. I go into the store and try things on.

**Jane:**

And so with that one item that you did buy, do you feel satisfied with your purchase?

**Allison:**

Yeah, I feel completely satisfied. I, I knew how I was going to wear it and how I was going to incorporate it into my wardrobe.

**Jane:**

Okay, so think about the last time. So maybe that was when you were in anthropology. You were standing in a store or in that dressing room and you weren't sure if you wanted to buy that item. You had it on, you weren't sure. Walk me through exactly what went through your head.

**Allison:**

Okay, sure. So when that happens, I will look at the quality of the item, I will look at the fit of the item. I will go ahead and sometimes leave the fitting room and go to the area where they have a three sided mirror so I can see like myself from different angles. If I look at the price and I look at the quality and it feels like it's a good fit. And I can see myself incorporating it into my wardrobe. I feel pretty confident that I can take that home. So there's a lot of factors that go into it. If I'm still confused, chances are I'm not going to buy it. I might ask a sales associate what they think, if they feel like it's a good fit, or I might send a picture of myself in it, you know, to a friend or family member. But most the time, I, I will think about those different criteria. The price, the quality, and can I see myself incorporating it into my wardrobe? Did I make a decision?

**Jane:**

Do you feel like the opinion that you get when you send a picture or maybe from the sales associate, do you ever feel like that will influence your decision?

**Allison:**

I especially think when it's like a family member or a friend more than the sales associate, because I understand the sales associate is just trying to make a sale. I mean, they're there to help, of course, but it's more reassuring when you ask a friend or family member and they give you the thumbs up.

**Jane:**

So what do you typically do when you're unsure whether a piece of clothing will look good on you? Not whether or not you'll buy it, but just if it will look good on you?

**Allison:**

Well, I try it on and I look at myself in the mirror. If I'm unsure if it's going to look good, I always want to try it on. So.

**Jane:**

Okay, so tell me about the last time you bought clothing that you ended up not wearing or rarely wearing. What happened?

**Allison:**

Yeah, so that has happened to me many, many times, unfortunately. And what happened is I bought something online and I tried it on. When I got it and it fit okay, it was fine. But then, you know, I missed the opportunity to return the item. Maybe the time, you know, ran out on being able to return it. And so it's just sitting in my closet unused, with tags on it, because I didn't really love it. And that's why I've really started to only buy clothes that I've tried on in the store, because I don't like to return.

**Jane:**

Okay. And do you feel like the same happens in store ever when you try things on?

**Allison:**

No, not. Not nearly as much. I mean, there are moments when I am contemplating should I get something, and there's even been moments when I went back to the store because I was kicking myself for not buying something. But when I try it on it in the store and I feel comfortable and confident in the outfit, then it's a much more positive experience for me. Yeah.

**Jane:**

So aside from shopping, I mean, after you get dressed in the morning, how often do you feel genuinely confident in what you're wearing? And what does it feel like when you don't feel confident?

**Allison:**

Yeah. Okay, so to answer the first part of your question, I would say 90% of the time, I feel confident I have a formula of, you know, different outfits that I like to wear, you know, that I feel confident in, that I feel comfortable in, and that I know are going to work out for me. To answer the second part of your question, what happens when I don't feel confident? Well, I will change. Like, I do not want to leave the house not feeling confident or comfortable. It's just a very rare occurrence that I would leave the house and something I don't feel good about wearing. Yeah.

**Jane:**

And you said that you have a formula that you've developed. How did you develop that formula?

**Allison:**

I think that's over. Over time of, you know, in my 20s and 30s, I was developing a sense of style and I would look, you know, I'd look at different, whether it be a magazine or Pinterest and look for different sty, style, inspiration, things that I thought I really liked and trying to find things that I thought would actually look good on me. And so that's really how I developed a sense of style. Trying things on, putting different outfits together, it's just kind of trial and error.

**Jane:**

Do you feel like you have always felt confident in, like, what you've purchased in store? Do you feel like you, Even in your 20s and 30s, did you have a similar situation where most of the time

you couldn't gauge what looked good on you in the store when trying it on and not end up with items that were going to waste, per se?

**Allison:**

No, I was not very good at that. Back in that time of my life. It really took years for me to develop my ability to pick out clothes and know if I was going to wear them and know that I was going to feel good about them once I left the store. So I think that just took a long time for me to figure out. And I didn't. I didn't have a personal stylist. I didn't have somebody like, helping me figure out outfits, which would have been great. But it was really a lot of trial and error, and I've made a lot of mistakes.

**Jane:**

Okay, so just my last question. I mean, the last time you were unsure whether something looked right on you, what information or reassurance would have helped you make that decision with confidence? Well,

**Allison:**

yeah, I think having somebody who is trusted give me some feedback on the outfit, whether it be in person or sending a picture or a video to somebody who I trust, tell me, like, yeah, that is not a good look for you, knowing that that would be the case. If somebody who I trusted really would give me that kind of feedback, that would be helpful.

**Jane:**

Okay, well, I really appreciate your answers. And speaking with you today, I'm working on something that would kind of solve this problem or solve kind of what we talked about. So when I develop it, I'll definitely reach out, and I'll maybe see what you think about it.

**Allison:**

Okay. That'd be great.

**Allison:**

Good luck with that.

**Jane:**

Thank you, Allison.

**Allison:**

You're so welcome

## **KEY TAKEAWAYS**

## **Shopping Decision Process**

- Always tries items on in-store before purchasing
  - Avoids returns by being certain before leaving store
  - Evaluates quality, fit, price, and wardrobe integration
- Uses three-sided mirrors for different angles when uncertain
- Decision factors: price-to-quality ratio + ability to incorporate into existing wardrobe

## **Confidence and Validation**

- Seeks external validation when unsure - sends photos to friends/family
  - Trusts friends/family opinions over sales associates (knows sales associates want to make sale)
- 90% of time feels confident getting dressed - has developed “formula” of outfits that work
- Will change clothes rather than leave house feeling unconfident

## **Online vs In-Store Experience Gap**

- Multiple items sitting unworn with tags from online purchases
  - Missed return windows on items that fit but weren’t loved
- In-store try-on much more successful - rarely results in unworn purchases
- Has gone back to stores to buy items she initially passed on

## **Style Development Journey**

- Took years to develop ability to pick clothes that she’d actually wear
- Trial and error process through 20s and 30s using magazines and Pinterest for inspiration
- Made many mistakes before developing current confidence level
- Would have benefited from personal stylist guidance

---

## **Customer Discovery Interview #2**

---

Interviewer: Jane Dias

Interviewee: Aly S. (Woman in 20s)

Customer Segment: Limited budget for clothing but would like to expand their wardrobe

Date June 7, 2026

Length 8 minutes

Location: Over the phone

Recording: Granola (audio + transcript)

## **TRANSCRIPT**

**Jane:**

Thank you so much for doing this. Is it okay if I record Aly?

**Aly:**

Yeah, that's totally fine, Jane.

**Jane:**

Awesome. Thank you. So I'm working on a class project, and basically, I'm just trying to understand how women make decisions when shopping for clothing. How they feel about the clothes that they buy and that they wear. No right or wrong answers. I'm just interested in hearing about your actual experiences. So, starting with my first question, walk me through the last time you went shopping for clothing alone. If you did and did you try things on, how did you decide what to buy, and did you feel satisfied with your purchase, and did you return anything?

**Aly:**

The last time I went shopping for clothes was when I got a new swimsuit at Target, and I didn't try it on because I don't like trying swimsuits on in the store. But when it's a different type of clothing, I'll try it on, and I was happy with my purchase.

**Jane:**

Okay, cool. So a little pivot. Like, think about the last time you were standing in a store or a dressing room and you weren't sure if you wanted to buy it. What exactly went through your head?

**Aly:**

Do I like to think. Okay, first of all, does it fit me? Important?

**Jane:**

Yep. Check.

**Aly:**

Do I have something that's, like this? Do I have something similar? Can I afford this right now? Is it. Is it special enough that I'm going to, you know, go out of my budget for it?

**Jane:**

So. Okay, those are definitely important factors. Another one is, like, what do you typically do when you're unsure whether a piece of clothing will look good on you, whether that's something, like, you pick up at the store or even if it's, like, on your body? What do you do if you're just unsure,

**Aly:**

Besides trying it on?

**Jane:**

Right.

**Aly:**

Yeah.

**Jane:**

Like, what do you do? Like, if you're not sure, like, does this look good on me?

**Aly:**

Oh, if I'm with somebody, I'd love to ask their opinion. If I'm shopping with somebody else, for sure. Like, oh, what do you think about this? Because especially if they're a close friend, they can really give a helping hand.

**Jane:**

Okay, perfect. Okay, let's see. Okay, tell me about the last time you bought clothing that you ended up not wearing or rarely wearing.

**Aly:**

I bought some athletic clothing from Old Navy, but I purchased it online, and because it was on sale, I couldn't return some of the items, and they just didn't fit, even though some of the other shirts that were the same size fit. So some of them fit, some of them didn't. And I just never wore the ones that didn't fit and I couldn't return them.

**Jane:**

Do you ever run into that scenario when you try things on in the store, like, where you'll buy it and you just never end up wearing it?

**Aly:**

Sometimes.

**Jane:**

Okay. Okay, next question.

**Aly:**

Not as often. Am I in person?

**Jane:**

No. That makes sense.

**Aly:**

Buying stuff on.

**Jane:**

Yeah, when it's online, it definitely changes things. Okay. After you get dressed in the morning, how often do you feel genuinely confident in what you're wearing and what does it feel like when you're not and when you don't feel confident in what you're wearing?

**Aly:**

I would say that maybe 50% of the time I wake up and put something on, but I'm like, yes, this is it. What was the rest of the question?

**Jane:**

Well, and I was just saying, what does it feel like when you don't? But I mean, 50% of the time, half the time. I mean, that's a good portion of the time where it's just like. Do you feel like it's like, eh, I'm not sure about this. Or is there, like, a specific part of your outfit that is sticking out to you that you don't like? And what do you think you do to supplement feeling better about it?

**Aly:**

So sometimes I will sacrifice. If I'm. If I'm lacking in the outfit, then I do my hair and makeup to make up for what's lacking in the outfit. But I feel like, you know, sometimes I'm just rocking a casual vibe and the outfit doesn't need to, you know, be perfect.

**Jane:**

Fair enough. Okay. And this is my last question. So the last time you were unsure whether your clothes looked good on you looked right on you. What information or reassurance would have helped you make the decision or feel confident?

**Aly:**

I feel like knowing, like, what kind of styles and silhouettes look good on your body is important, and sometimes it's hard to figure that out in the store. I think also knowing what colors look good on you is important because I feel like, because I'm kind of pale, a lot of colors wash me out, and sometimes I'll still pick up a color that doesn't look good on me, even though. And if I knew, like, okay, stay away from this color, I would stop doing that. So I feel like knowing what looks good on you is very helpful. And also other people's opinions that you trust.

**Jane:**

Okay, perfect. And is that. Do you feel like you use. What do you feel like you do to feel like something looks good on you? What did like to you? If you were to explain this to someone,



like, oh, this is how I explore my style or this is how I know something looks good on me, like, what would you say? Tough question.

**Aly:**

It just makes you feel good about yourself and you feel confident and like, oh, I would feel fine if I would, like took a picture in this outfit. Like, you know, I want to go out and be seen and go, you know, go to dinner with my friends or go hang out in this outfit.

**Jane:**

Okay, well, makes you want to leave the house. Okay, perfect. So, okay, so when I'm working on this thing that's basically like kind of trying to solve a problem that's like within this area. So whenever I finish it, I'll reach out to you and let you know.

**Aly:**

Thanks for interviewing me.

**Jane:**

Of course.

## **TAKEWAYS**

### **Shopping Decision Process**

- Key factors when unsure about purchase: fit, uniqueness (do I have something similar?), affordability, special enough to go over budget
- Seeks opinions from close friends when shopping together for honest feedback
- Online purchases more problematic than in-store - sizing inconsistencies even within same brand/size at Old Navy
- Swimsuits never tried on in store due to discomfort

### **Clothing Confidence Patterns**

- Feels genuinely confident in outfit choice ~50% of mornings
- Compensates for weak outfit with enhanced hair/makeup effort
- Sometimes embraces casual vibe without needing “perfect” outfit
- Confident outfit = willing to take photos, go out to dinner with friends, be seen publicly

### **Style Knowledge Gaps**

- Struggles to identify which silhouettes work best for her body type - hard to figure out in store

- Color selection challenging due to pale complexion - many colors wash her out
- Continues picking unflattering colors despite knowing better
- Wants clearer guidance on “stay away from this color” rules

### Customer Discovery Interview #3

---

Interviewer: Jane Dias

Interviewee: Danai (A Preschool teacher and business owner)

Customer Segment: Very good with money and does not like to spend a lot on clothes

Date June 7, 2026

Length 9 minutes

Location: Over the phone

Recording: Granola (audio + transcript)

#### TRANSCRIPT

**Jane:**

Hi, Danai. Thank you so much for doing this. Like I mentioned, I'm just working on a class project, trying to understand how women make decisions when shopping for clothing. How they feel about the clothes they buy and wear. There's no right or wrong answers. I'm just interested in hearing about your actual experiences. And do you mind if I record this?

**Danai:**

I don't mind.

**Jane:**

All right. Okay, so jumping into the first question. Walk me through the last time you went shopping for clothing alone. Did you try things on? How did you decide what to buy? Did you feel satisfied with your purchase? And did you return anything?

**Danai:**

Ooh. Okay. So I am a big online shopper, so I tend to shop. So yeah, I shop alone all the time because I'm online.

**Jane:**

Yeah.

**Danai:**

So I try to get my size, but I would say last time I was trying to buy things for summer just to kind of update my summer wardrobe. Shorts and tanks and things. And I did have to return a couple things that just. It wasn't so much that it was the wrong size. It just didn't fit my body

well. So I just tried to find something else. So that was my last experience was online. And yes, I did return a couple of the things. Right.

**Jane:**

And so I know you said you're an online shopper, so maybe this next question could apply to that. But think about the last time you were standing in a store or a dressing room or maybe even trying on what you bought online and you weren't sure whether to buy something or keep something. Walk me through exactly what went through through your head.

**Danai:**

Okay. So I would say so. Actually, last time I was in North Carolina, I did go shopping with my daughter in law and I did try on a few things. I felt very frustrated because my body type is a little bit different where I have like a smaller waist, but I have bigger, like hips and thighs. And so a lot of pants and shorts fit me kind of weird. And it's like usually when I find a short that fits me great, I'll just buy in every color. Right. So I sat there and I do remember feeling a little sad at the end of our day. Cause I really didn't find anything that really worked for me. Yeah.

**Jane:**

And so what do you do when you are unsure whether a piece of clothing will look good on you or looks good on you?

**Danai:**

Okay, sorry. I can say.

**Jane:**

I can ask you.

**Danai:**

I'm sorry. Okay. Yeah.

**Jane:**

So what do you, like, do when like you have a piece of clothing on and you're unsure if it will look good? On you, or if it does look good on you.

**Danai:**

Okay. If I'm alone, I'll take a picture of myself in it, and I'll send it to my husband or to, like, one of my sisters or even one of my kids and ask them. And they're everybody that I send it to. I know they'll be honest. And if they are hesitant in any way, I just won't get it.

**Jane:**

Yeah.

**Danai:**

But if I'm feeling really confident in it, I'll just buy it right then. Okay. This will work.

**Jane:**

Awesome.

**Danai:**

There are times that you're confident at the store, and you get home and then you go to put it on again, and you're like, no, never mind.

**Jane:**

Yeah. I mean, maybe in this next question, I mean, tell me about the last time you bought something that you ended up not wearing or rarely wearing. What happened?

**Danai:**

Yeah, so it was one of those situations where I don't know if maybe the store mirror and the lights just made it look like it looked amazing. And then when I got home and actually saw it in real light in my bathroom, I was like, what the hell was I thinking? Like, I thought, you know, and then. And then I just was, like, kind of lazy. I'm like, I don't want to return it, so how can I make it work? Like, can I wear it with, like, a sweater or can I dress it up this way? So I have worn it a couple times, but I'll be honest, it's just staying in my closet. Yeah.

**Jane:**

And does that situation happen to you? Do you feel like you run into that situation frequently? Not very often. Can or do you have, like. Is that something that is, like, frequent for you?

**Danai:**

It's not super often. Well, the keeping it definitely is not often. I'm. I'm kind of a penny finisher, so I'd rather get my money back or get something I am gonna wear. So that's why the online shopping is so much easier, because then I can just go return it at ups and then, you know.

**Jane:**

Right.

**Danai:**

The next size or something different. Different color. Yeah.

**Jane:**

Okay, so this next question is maybe not in the realm of shopping so much, but maybe more so just, like, getting dressed. But after you get dressed in the morning, how often do you feel genuinely confident in what you're wearing? And what does it feel like when you don't?

**Danai:**

Okay. So, yeah, I think I feel generally confident when I get dressed in the morning. I usually kind of think about it the night before. I try to, like, set my clothes out just because of work, but I will say so the difference is I'm confident in that outfit as far as going and teaching. Teaching

preschool, but I'm not confident to wear that outfit out and about. Yeah. Because then I'm like, oh, I look like I'm going to preschool.

**Jane:**

Right. Because you have a specific style you

**Danai:**

wear for your preschool. I mean, you generally change after work. If I'm gonna go somewhere else.

**Jane:**

Yeah. And like, with those outfits, then. So, like, kind of outside of your work formula, you may have created, like, how about that? Those outfits.

**Danai:**

Yeah, I feel. I feel confident. Okay. Awesome. Yeah.

**Jane:**

And so this is my last question. The last time you were unsure whether something looked right on you, what information or reassurance would have helped you make the decision with confidence?

**Danai:**

What? Okay, wait. Say that one more time. Sorry.

**Jane:**

So, yeah, the last time you were unsure whether something looked right on you, what information or reassurance advice of that nature would have helped you make a decision with confidence, knowing whether or not it looked good on you?

**Danai:**

I. I mean, I think I just go off my own gut feeling like, you know, what. What am I trying to put out into the world? Like what? Like. Like, you know what I mean? Like, when you get dressed, you're like, if you're going to dress like a hoochie mommy, that's probably like, what you're trying to put out in the world. Right. But if I'm trying to dress like, you know, my age. Right. So I do look at things like that. Am I trying to dress too young? Am I trying to dress too old? Am I. Is this okay? Right. So that. That's more about how I feel about stuff, more than the fit. Because I pretty much have figured out the fit, right?

**Jane:**

Yeah.

**Danai:**

But I think. I think just taking a deep breath and being completely honest with myself, like, okay, this actually isn't very flattering, besides the other things of asking your husband or taking a picture. Yeah, right.

**Jane:**

Yeah, exactly. Okay, well, thank you so much. I'm working on something that would maybe help solve this problem in this realm. So once I have something, I'll definitely show you and see what you think.

**Danai:**

That'd be awesome. I will tell you, Jane, that one of the things that has been so helpful with clothes, and I'm pretty sure it's probably helpful for a lot of women, is I try to find an influencer that has my body type, and then I follow them, and I'm like, okay, yeah, she's figured out because I'm not good at it. Yeah. Figured out what looks good on our body type. And then I kind of just go from there.

**Jane:**

Yeah, 100%.

**Danai:**

My little tidbit. No.

**Jane:**

Awesome.

## **TAKEAWAYS**

### **Shopping Preferences & Habits**

- Primarily shops online alone vs in-store
- Last purchase: summer wardrobe update (shorts, tanks)
- Returns common due to fit issues rather than sizing problems
- When finds shorts that fit well, buys in every color
- Prefers online shopping for easier returns via UPS

### **Body Fit Challenges & Frustrations**

- Body type: smaller waist, bigger hips and thighs
- Pants and shorts fit “weird” due to proportions
- Recent in-store experience with daughter-in-law left her feeling “sad” - couldn’t find anything that worked
- Store mirrors and lighting can be misleading vs home lighting

### **Decision-Making When Uncertain**

- Takes photos and sends to husband, sisters, or kids for honest feedback
- Won't buy if trusted contacts show any hesitation
- Sometimes confident in store but changes mind at home
- Occasionally keeps items she's unsure about, tries to make them work with styling

### **Confidence & Style Considerations**

- Generally confident getting dressed for work (preschool teaching)
- Has separate "work formula" vs going-out clothes
- Changes after work if going elsewhere
- Considers age-appropriateness: "Am I trying to dress too young? Too old?"
- Uses gut feeling about what image she wants to project

### **Helpful Strategies**

- Follows influencers with similar body type for styling inspiration
- Takes deep breath and practices self-honesty about fit
- Plans outfits night before for work
- Prefers returning items rather than keeping unworn clothes

## **Customer Discovery Interview #4**

---

Interviewer: Jane Dias

Interviewee: Mya (In her 20s)

Customer Segment: Limited budget for clothing

Date June 7, 2026

Length 8 minutes

Location: Over the phone

Recording: Granola (audio + transcript)

### **TRANSCRIPT**

**Jane:**

Hey, Mya. Thank you so much for doing this.

**Mya:**

You're so welcome.

**Jane:**

Is it okay if I record this?

**Mya:**

Oh, absolutely.

**Jane:**

Okay, so just going over it again with you. I'm working on a class project, and I'm trying to understand how women make decisions when shopping for clothes or even just getting dressed, and maybe even how they feel about the clothes that they buy and wear. There's no right or wrong answers. I'm just interested in hearing about your actual experiences. So I'm gonna just hop into the first question. So walk me through the last time you went shopping for clothing. Whether that was the last time you did it alone or maybe even with people. Did you try things on? How did you decide what to buy? Do you feel satisfied with your purchase? Did you return anything?

**Mya:**

Okay, I went to Dillard's, and I bought some dresses, and I did go with people, and I ended up liking, like, three things, and I brought them home.

**Jane:**

Okay. And did you, like, feel satisfied with them? And did you return anything?

**Mya:**

I. I felt satisfied, and also, I couldn't return anything because it was Dillard's.

**Jane:**

Oh, okay. Fair enough. And when you were trying things on, I'm assuming because you're with people, you were, like, asking them what they thought of what you were trying on. Were you just trying them on?

**Mya:**

Yes. Oh, of course. I think that's a big part of shopping, and for me, it's kind of, like, social. And it is a lot easier when you have people with you, because I do think half of the time, if somebody is like, that looks good, then I'm like, that will push me to buy it. And I'll be like, I kind of do need people to tell me what it looks like, because I can't see. I can't get a 360 of myself sometimes. And also, it's just like, if my friends tell me it looks good, I'm

**Jane:**

like, it, like, hypes up, maybe. Yeah, I can see that. Think about the last time you were standing in a store or a dressing room and you weren't sure whether or not to buy something. Walk me through exactly what went through your head.



**Mya:**

Okay. If I'm not sure if I like something? So I guess, yeah, I tried some dresses on that I. I was not sure about. And one of the first things that goes through my head is, is it a good fit? Where. What events will I wear this to? Will I even wear it as I buy it? And then I think maybe the third thing I would think about is, like, maybe I should go out of the dressing room and, like, see what my friends think. See what? What does my sister think? Does she think I would wear this? Does it look good on me?

**Jane:**

Okay. And what do you do? What do you typically do when you're unsure whether a piece of clothing will look good on you or even looks good on you? And maybe you already kind of answered this.

**Mya:**

That. But okay, I definitely take pictures. I'll try to take a video of myself and do, like, a spin to see. See if I can get a good view. But again, I really do think a big part of it for me is just, like, asking the people that I'm with, like, yeah, what do you think? You know? And that really does help me decide.

**Jane:**

Tell me about the last time you bought something that you ended up not wearing or rarely wearing. What happened?

**Mya:**

Oh, the last time I bought something and I didn't like it or didn't wear it often, I bought. I picked something up at Target. It was like a tube top, and I didn't have time to try it on, and it was on sale, so I just bought it. And when I came home, I realized I hated it and I never wore it. Hmm.

**Jane:**

It happens after you get dressed in the morning. This is kind of a pivot. This next question. Kind of away from shopping. This next question. So after you get dressed in the morning, how often do you feel genuinely confident in what you're wearing? And what does it feel like when you don't feel confident in what you're wearing?

**Mya:**

I'm gonna say, and maybe feel confident about the actual outfit, like, let's say 40 of the time. And I feel like a lot of that is just because I wear, like, gym clothes most of the time. And so I'm like, it's not like, it's just like, for utility. It's not. Yeah. So, yeah, I mean, if I'm not wearing a good outfit, though, I don't want to be so seen in public. So that's the. That's the feeling that goes through my head.

**Jane:**

Okay. And like, I guess, like, so you're wearing gym clothes. Obviously, it's utility. It's like, kind of situational based sometimes when you're just getting dressed in the morning, but, like, when you're throwing together a fit, I guess. What do you say? Like, makes you. How often do you think you feel confident in those things? And then what makes you feel confident in. Yeah, the same. The same kind of thing.

**Mya:**

Okay. I. I feel like I feel confident in a going out outfit. Maybe, like, maybe 50 of the time. And I do think what helps me feel confident is getting input from other people. If they're like, why your outfit looks great, or I do think that helps.

**Jane:**

Okay. And so the last time you were unsure, if an outfit looked right on you, something looked right on you, what information or reassurance would have helped you to make the decision with confidence?

**Mya:**

Okay. I'm trying to think what would make me, again, like, taking pictures and seeing if I like how I look in the pictures. Or again, like, asking. Sometimes I'll, like, FaceTime my mom and be like, do you like this outfit? Or I'll ask my twin sister. I'll be like, does this look good? Like, before I go out? So that type of thing definitely helps.

**Jane:**

Do you feel like when you talk to your mom or your sister, do they ever say, like, no, it doesn't look good? Or do they ever say, like, yeah, I guess that's what I'm asking. Like, what kind of input do you feel like it's unbiased input that they give you?

**Mya:**

It really depends. Like, I do think my mom is kind of brutal, and she'll be like, that doesn't look good. But then sometimes when you do ask a friend, they're just trying to be nice, and they won't give you, I feel, like, real input on the outfit. So I do think it really depends on the relationship. So sometimes, yes, I'll give a real answer and I'll fix my outfit and they'll give me real input. But sometimes I do feel like people are just trying to be nice.

**Jane:**

Well, Mya, thank you for answering my questions. I'm working on something basically, kind of to solve a problem in this area. And once I've kind of come up with something or have something to show, I'll definitely reach out to you and see what you think. Think.

**Mya:**

Great. I'm excited.

**Jane:**

Thank you, Mya.

## TAKEAWAYS

### Shopping Decision Process

- Social validation crucial to purchase decisions
  - Brings friends/family for 360-degree perspective and confidence boost
  - “If somebody is like, that looks good, then I’m like, that will push me to buy it”
  - Takes photos/videos in dressing room for self-assessment
- Key decision factors when unsure: fit quality, occasion planning, likelihood of actually wearing
- Impulse purchases without trying on lead to regret (Target tube top example)

### Confidence in Daily Outfits

- Feels genuinely confident ~40% of time in regular clothes, 50% in going-out outfits
- Gym clothes worn frequently for utility, not confidence
- When not confident: “I don’t want to be so seen in public”
- Confidence boosters: positive feedback from others, good photos of outfit

### Information Sources & Validation

- Mom gives “brutal” honest feedback vs friends who are “just trying to be nice”
- FaceTimes mom and twin sister for outfit approval before going out
- Values unbiased input but recognizes relationship dynamics affect honesty
- Pictures and videos help with self-assessment when alone

### Customer Discovery Interview #5

Week 3 | BUS 395: Venture Creation with AI

---

Interviewer: Jane Dias

Interviewee: Meg (woman in her 30s with children)

Customer Segment: Worked in fashion

Date June 7, 2026

Length 13 minutes

Location: Over the phone

Recording: Granola (audio + transcript)

**TRANSCRIPT****Jane:**

Thank you so much for doing this. So, as we talked about, I'm working on a class project, and I'm trying to understand how women make decisions when shopping for clothing and how they feel about the clothes that they buy and wear. So there's no right or wrong answers. I'm just interested in hearing about your actual experiences. Do you mind if I record this?

**Meg:**

Yeah, sure.

**Jane:**

All right. Okay. So first question. Walk me through the last time you went shopping for clothing alone. Did you try anything on? How did you decide what to buy, and did you end up feeling satisfied with your purchase, or did you return anything?

**Meg:**

The last time I went shopping alone was probably when I was getting ready for my trip to London in February, and I went to the Florida mall, and I went to, I think, a couple of department stores looking for. I was looking specifically for colors for the wedding I was going to. So I was trying to find a dress in a specific color, and it was. It was challenging. I will say that.

**Jane:**

Yeah. Finding something with a specific color always makes things really challenging.

**Meg:**

Yes.

**Jane:**

And with that, like, if. If you ended up finding something, did you feel satisfied with that purchase?

**Meg:**

You know, the thing is, is I ended up borrowing a dress from somebody, but I ended up finding other things while I was out shopping that I purchased and I did like. So I found some great sweaters and some things like that that I really liked and I did keep, and I actually took those on my trip. Oh. So I did have some shopping success, even though what I had initially kind of was hunting for, I didn't. I didn't find. Mm.

**Jane:**

So moving on. I mean, think about the last time you were standing in a store or a dressing room and you weren't sure whether to buy something. Walk me through exactly what went through your head.

**Meg:**

Usually I'm looking for a combination of price. Does it fit within the budget I'm trying to shop for? Am I going to be able to wear this more than one time? Will I want to? Does it seem like it's good quality? Will it hold up in the wash? Am I going to have to do something special to get it clean? And does it look good? And, you know, as someone who's been through a lot of changes in her body between, you know, getting older, having babies, different things like that, it definitely presents challenges and finding something that look, you think looks good. So those are the types of things that I'm thinking about, like the cost, how it looks. Well, first of all, it has to look good. It doesn't matter how, how little, or what A good deal. It is. If it doesn't look good, you're not gonna buy it. But it has to fit within my budget, and it needs to. It needs to look. Look good, I think a good value. I think I. I sometimes don't mind getting, like, a fast fashion item if I think that. I don't know once in a while, but I usually like to know if it's going to last for a little bit. Sure. Yeah.

**Jane:**

Like, you like to have, like, it's like a material thing as well. Well, like, you like to have something that will last a while.

**Meg:**

Yeah.

**Jane:**

Okay, so I have another question. Okay, this is my next question for you. Tell me about the last time. If there was a last time that you bought clothing that you ended up not wearing or rarely wearing, what happened?

**Meg:**

Yeah, if I didn't end up wearing it, it's because I probably didn't try it on first. And usually it's something that I've purchased online. One time, I accidentally bought a pair of jeans. I don't remember where they were from, but, you know, they were curvy. Or is that they were for a curvy body. And I. But they were in my size. But I didn't realize that. I thought, oh, you know what? I got a little extra meat on my bum. Like, yeah, curvy might be even better for me. Yeah. But it actually, I didn't understand that it was for a different type of proportions. I only found out later that curvy means that the waist is small and the hips are bigger in proportion. But I have the opposite. I got more narrow hips and a thicker waist. And so I'm like, what? These are my size size. And they did not fit at all.

**Jane:**

I mean, that makes it more complicated.

**Meg:**

Yeah, I had no idea. I mean, but I can see how that's really useful for some people. I took Ren out to the mall on Saturday or a week ago Saturday, and she could not find jeans in her. She really

couldn't find jeans that fit. So we went to American Eagle Outfitters, and she wanted new jean shorts. And they. They just. Nothing really seemed to fit in the waist. Everything was. Even the triple zero was too small or was too big. Oh, my gosh, the hicks were tight, and the waist was too big. It was tight in the hips, baggy in the waist. So for her, like, actually getting something in, like a zero, a double zero, curvy would be perfect for her, but they didn't have that. An American Eagle for her. But, you know, we were struggling to find her shorts. That fit and come to find out, because she has a disproportionately smaller waist to hip ratio, the lower rise cheese shorts, we found one pair that, that sat a little bit lower on the hips and those worked, but if it was around the waist, just didn't. Just didn't work at all.

**Jane:**

So it sounds like a lot of like, trial and error. And also I didn't know that about the curvy proportions. So that's like, good to know and that's very interesting.

**Meg:**

Yeah. I mean, gosh, I guess that's lucky if you're in a situation where you've got, you know, I've never experienced that, so I don't know what it would be like to have a true curvy figure. So I was thinking about ordering some for rent to try. You know, Abercrombie carries them and probably a couple other brands do as well. But.

**Jane:**

Yeah, yeah, I mean, and you said that like to avoid like not wearing clothing. Usually that comes with not trying something on. Do you ever feel like you have a scenario where you did try it on in the store and for some reason you just never ended up wearing that? Is that a situation that happens to you?

**Meg:**

If I went out shopping more, it might. I find that I don't go out shopping a ton because I hate taking my 4 year old out to the stores. It's annoying. Yeah. Every place is like a playground to him. So as a mom with little kids, I find that I just don't even go in and try stuff on very often. I find a time when I can go by myself or just take, you know, a 13 year old. Right. But yeah, I'm sure that has happened. And the reason why I think that's happened for me in the past, whether it's like a shirt or a pair of pants or a dress or something, is, you know, I tried it on, it looked good. And then I don't know, maybe the material ended up being kind of uncomfortable or it wore it out one time and you know, like I was annoyed by something that it did. Like maybe the shorts ended up riding up a little bit in the, you know, in the thigh area the whole time and it kind of bugs the crap out of me or things like that where until you actually start wearing the item out of it, you almost don't know if you like it. You think you do, but something about it can bug you when you actually put it on and wear it out 100%.

**Jane:**

And then this is kind of like shifting away from like buying clothing. But More so like getting dressed. So after you get dressed in the morning, how often do you feel genuinely confident in what you're wearing? And what does it feel like when you don't feel confident?

**Meg:**

Confident? I very rarely feel confident in what I'm wearing, but it's mostly a body image issue. But I feel, I feel comfortable and the most confident when my clothing is not too tight.

**Jane:**

Yeah.

**Meg:**

So especially in the waist. I have a much thicker waist and so I need comfort there. And if I feel like it's com. My clothes are pretty comfortable in the waist and they're breathable. Especially here in Florida. The other day I took the kids to the, to Walt Disney World and I was wearing like a short sleeve cotton button up shirt and linen shorts. And I have never been so comfortable out in that, like the heat as I was wearing that. So I did feel like comfortable and confident in that just because I felt like, I don't know, I felt like cool, breezy, even though it was just blazing hot and humid outside. So having for me the right fabrics and the right size, I mean, everything has to be in the right size and it has to get. If it's hot out, I need airflow.

**Jane:**

So, yeah, perfect. And so this is my, my last question. The last time you were unsure whether something looked right on you or looked good on you, what information or reassurance would have helped you make that decision with confidence?

**Meg:**

I don't know because I don't know if I can. I mean, like, maybe if somebody who was skilled in knowing what looks good on certain body types. Yeah, but everyone's got a different body type. Some things look better on certain bodies than others. So, you know, maybe just having some information like, about my dimensions and like, hey, like, you know what, that, that type of waist doesn't look great. You know, if you're my boobs, if they're a certain size, maybe something the neckline may be looking right. I don't know, maybe just I'm not sure who or what could give me that kind of information. Like, you know, maybe that dress would look better if you put on some shapewear underneath. Yeah. Yeah, I see. I don't know. Oh, gosh.

**Jane:**

Well, thank you so much for your answers. So basically I'm working on something maybe that could help solve this problem or problems in this area. So once I have something, I'll definitely show you and see what you think.

**Meg:**

All right.

**Jane:**

Thank you so much.

**Meg:**

Yeah, you're welcome.

## TAKEAWAYS

### Shopping Decision-Making Process

- Primary factors when deciding to buy: price/budget fit, versatility (multiple wears), quality/durability, ease of care, appearance
- Appearance is non-negotiable baseline - “doesn’t matter how good a deal it is if it doesn’t look good”
- Willing to buy fast fashion occasionally but prefers items that will last
- Online purchases more likely to go unworn due to fit issues

### Sizing and Fit Challenges

- “Curvy” sizing confusion - didn’t realize it meant small waist/big hips ratio vs her body type (narrow hips/thicker waist)
- Daughter Ren also struggles with fit: triple zero too small or too big, tight hips but baggy waist
- Lower-rise styles worked better for Ren’s proportions
- Body changes over time (aging, pregnancy) create ongoing fit challenges

### Shopping Behavior Patterns

- Shops alone when possible - avoids bringing 4-year-old (“every place is like a playground to him”)
- Recent trip: hunting for specific wedding dress color, ended up borrowing dress but found other items (sweaters)
- Prefers to try on in-store but often shops online due to convenience with kids

### Confidence and Comfort

- Rarely feels genuinely confident in clothing - mostly body image related
- Most confident when clothes aren’t too tight, especially around waist
- Fabric choice crucial in Florida heat - cotton button-up and linen shorts provided comfort and confidence at Disney World
- Comfort factors: right size, breathable fabrics, airflow in hot weather



## Potential Solution Needs

- Expressed uncertainty about what information could help with fit/styling decisions
- Mentioned wanting guidance from someone skilled in body-type styling
- Suggested dimensional information and specific recommendations (necklines, shapewear, etc.)
- Unclear who or what could provide this type of personalized guidance

## **KEY TAKEAWAYS FROM ALL INTERVIEWS - Using ClaudeAI**

### **Core Problem: Confidence in How Clothes Look on Your Body**

Every interviewee struggled with the same fundamental question, *does this actually look good on me?*, and none had a reliable way to answer it alone.

---

### **1. External Validation is the Universal Coping Mechanism**

All 5 women cope with outfit uncertainty the same way: asking someone they trust. They send photos to husbands, sisters, moms, and friends. But this system is flawed, sales associates are biased, and even friends are sometimes "just trying to be nice" (Mya). **There's a gap between needing honest feedback and reliably getting it.**

### **2. Online Shopping Amplifies the Problem**

Every interviewee had unworn items from online purchases. The common thread wasn't wrong sizing, it was that things *fit* but didn't *look right* on their specific body. Returns are a workaround, not a solution.

### **3. Body Proportions Are the Real Pain Point**

Multiple women described their body as "hard to fit", Danai (small waist, bigger hips/thighs), Meg (narrow hips, thicker waist), Aly (coloring/complexion affecting what works). Standard sizing doesn't account for proportions, and women largely figure this out through years of trial and error.

### **4. Style Knowledge Takes Years to Develop**

Allison articulated what others implied: developing a reliable "formula" for dressing well took decades. Younger interviewees (Aly, Mya) are still in that trial-and-error phase. **Women want a shortcut to knowing what works for their specific body.**

### **5. Confidence Has Real Stakes**

Low outfit confidence means not wanting to leave the house (Mya), changing entirely before going out (Allison), or compensating with hair/makeup (Aly).

---

The clearest signal across all interviews: women want trusted, honest, personalized feedback on whether something looks good *on their specific body*, accounting for proportions, coloring, and style, without having to rely on a biased sales associate or a polite friend.